Lesson plan · for the teacher

Social media, pupils' photos and you

Cyber security · Level 3 · Lesson 3

Time	Materials
40 min	Board and chalk; Three photos described on cards or drawn on the board; Paper for the class's five photo rules

Learning goals

- Decide whether a pupil photo can be posted, and how.
- Find the details in a photo that give a child away.
- Keep personal and school accounts apart, and spot a fake school page.

Activity: Photo detectives

1. Warm-up (5 min): Tell the story of the teacher with forty sports-day photos. Ask: which would you be happy to see online, and which not?
2. Teach (8 min): Write three questions on the board: who, where, when? Explain how a name, a school gate, a list on the board or a location tag answers them.
3. Detectives (15 min): Show the three photos. In groups, pupils list every detail that answers who, where or when. Walk around and ask what a stranger could do with each one.
4. Share (7 min): Each group fixes one photo: crop it, take it from behind, drop the name, post it later. Compare the fixes.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Turn the best ideas into five photo rules for the class, written on paper for the wall.

Prepare three photo descriptions on cards, or quick drawings: a close-up of a winner with her full name; a group at the school gate with the date and time; the team seen from behind. Use no real pupils.

Discussion

- Would you mind a stranger seeing this photo of you?
- Which detail is easiest to miss?
- What should the school do if a parent says no?

Exit ticket

- One detail that gives a child away + how to remove it.

Try it at school tomorrow

Describe three photos, or draw them on the board: a close-up of a winner with her full name, a group at the school gate with the date and time, and a team seen from behind. Pupils find every detail that gives away who, where or when, and suggest how to make each one safe to share.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **A pupil sends you a friend request on your personal account. What do you do?**

- ◯ Decline kindly, and use the school's official channels
- ◯ Accept — it's friendly
- ◯ Accept, but hide your posts from them

2 **Once a parent has signed the consent form, it's fine to post their child's photo with the child's full name.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

3 **What in a school photo could give a child away?**

- ☐ The school's name on their jumpers
- ☐ A blue sky
- ☐ A list of names on the board behind them
- ☐ A location tag stored in the photo file
- ☐ Pupils seen from behind, in a group

4 **A parent asks you to remove a photo of their child from the school page. Put the steps in order.**

- ☐ Check other school pages and groups for copies
- ☐ Tell the parent everything you removed and changed
- ☐ Thank the parent and remove the photo the same day
- ☐ Update the consent list so future photos leave the child out

5 **Match each detail to what it gives away.**

A full name under a face	• • • •	Exactly where it was taken
The school gate in the photo	• • • •	Where the group is right now
A photo's location tag	• • • •	Who the child is
Posting a trip while it's happening	• • • •	Where the child is every weekday

✎ **Think of the last school photo you shared or saw shared. What would you change before posting it now?**

Check your answers

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1 **Decline kindly, and use the school's official channels**

A personal account mixes your private life with your pupils', and private messages between a teacher and a pupil leave both of you unprotected.

2 **False**

Even with consent, a full name next to a face lets anyone look the child up and find them.

3 **The school's name on their jumpers; A list of names on the board behind them; A location tag stored in the photo file**

The school's name says where the child is every day, the list adds names, and a location tag gives the exact place.

4 **Top to bottom: 2, 4, 1, 3**

Remove it first, because every hour more people can see and save it.

5 **A full name under a face — Who the child is**
The school gate in the photo — Where the child is every weekday
A photo's location tag — Exactly where it was taken
Posting a trip while it's happening — Where the group is right now

Who, where and when: each detail answers one of a stranger's questions.